ART

# A LIFETIME OF SCULPTURES



An exhibition at Triveni Kala Sangam, Delhi, showcases five decades of veteran sculptor **Biman B. Das**'s oeuvre

A recent retrospective of master sculptor and Padma Shri-awardee Biman B. Das is a homage spanning five decades. Showcasing a collection of the veteran artist's works from 1974 to 2024, it includes sculptures in bronze, terracotta, marble and wood as well as paintings in watercolour.

Das's sculptures traverse four major themes—Hindu mythology, Buddhism, abstraction and portraiture. Inspired by the representations of gods and goddesses in temples and manuscripts, he sculpts his own interpretation of their traditional forms. "He is as much a sculptor as he is a devotee, and his works are an ode to the divine conceived through serene contemplation. They are as such not merely art but moments in his journey within," says Geeta Singh, director, Art Pilgrim gallery.

The historic town of Tamluk in West Bengal where Das was born in 1943 has been his greatest inspiration. "It had many ancient Indian sculptures, and the river that flowed through it was filled with terracotta, which became the medium of my early works. There was also a maker of Durga sculptures who worked near my home. As a child, I would observe him modelling," he says.

Das's experimentation with different mediums began when he was a National Cultural Scholar with the Government of India. An alumnus of the Government College of Art & Craft, Calcutta, where he also served as principal, he was a lecturer at the College



**THE MASTERPIECES**
L-R, 'Shakti-I' (bronze), 2003; 'Buddha-I' (bronze), 2023-24; 'Krishna Cult-II' (black marble), 2019

# *Contemporary* CREATIONS

**BARODA BUZZ** AT DELHI'S GALLERY ART POSITIVE PLUGS INTO CURRENT TRENDS IN THE BARODA SCHOOL OF ART

A new exhibition in the capital celebrates the vibrant artistic spirit of Baroda. Often known as one of India's important art hubs, the city has supported art that boomed and flourished during the rule of Maharaja Sayajirao Gaekwad III in the 19th century. An artist group that was founded in 1956 by N.S. Bendre, the Baroda School comprises artists associated with the Faculty of Fine Arts, Maharaja Sayajirao University, Baroda. The school marked a move away from the Revivalist inclinations of groups such as the Bengal School as well as the academic realism practised by European schools.

The exhibition aims to plug into the current art trends that are emerging from the city, which has supported artists since Independence. Emerging from these studios are a number of artistic languages ranging from minimalistic abstraction to rich figurative artwork. There are also a variety of mediums and materials that appeal to the artists who often tread a multidisciplinary ground of expression, moving from stitched and burnished surfaces, to prints and sculptures, installations and panels. The exhibition also mirrors current concerns related to the global environment, gender equality as well as personal stories that speak of cultural and social practices.

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Bansi Dholakiya is deeply inspired by the landscapes of Gujarat. "The memories of the infinite-looking paddy fields, deserts, farms and salt pans I wandered as a child, revisit me through my works," she says. The modulations and variations of the state's different terrains are transformed into abstract landscapes in her works. Food and the politics behind its production and consumption have been the most concerning

